

9 Using Commands

You can follow the `mv` command with either of these two options:

- `i`. makes the Terminal ask your permission before replacing a file with one of the same name.
- `-f`. Overwrites like-named files without asking you permission. Actually, this is the default way in which `mv` works if you don't specify otherwise.

9.3.2 `mkdir`: Create New Directories

In Terminal, you create a new folder using the `mkdir` command (for make directory). Follow the command with the name you wish to give the new directory, like this: `mkdir 'Digit Fast Track'` (the single quotes let you avoid having to precede each space with a backslash). By default, the `mkdir` command will create the new directory in the current working directory, although you can just as easily create it anywhere else. You just need to add the pathname to your argument.

Note

The `mv` command will never replace one directory with an identically named one (or an identically named file). If there is such an item, only those named differently from any subdirectories in the target directory will be moved.

9.3.3 `touch`: Creating Empty Files

To create a new, empty file, you can type `touch filename`. For example, to create the file `digit.txt` in your working directory, type `touch digit.txt` in Terminal.

9.3.4 `rm`: Removing Files and Directories

Unix provides an extremely efficient and easy way to trash files and directories. With a single command, `rm`, you can delete any file or directory that you're allowed to access with your account type.

To use this command, just type `rm`, a space, and the exact filename of the file you want to delete from the working directory. To remove the file `digit.txt` you created with the `touch` command, for example, you'd just type `rm digit.txt`. To remove a directory and everything inside it, add the `-r` flag, like this: `rm -r trailers`.

You can even use wildcards such as `*` with the `rm` command. If you want to delete everything in the working directory, use `rm -r *`

Just after the letters `rm`, you can insert flags such as:

- `-d` deletes any empty directories it finds, in addition to files. (Otherwise, empty directories trigger an error message.)
- `-i` makes the Mac ask you for confirmation before deleting each file or directory.